

Mind the Mistake — Answers

Final answers with a one-line reason. For full methods, see the worked examples in the notes.

Objective

Q1 (b) $25m^2 + 60mn + 36n^2$. Don't drop the middle term.

Q2 (a) $15p^2 - 6pq$. Multiply $-3p$ by each term.

Q3 10. $-2 + 12 = 10$.

Q4 (c) **cannot be simplified further**. $5w^2$ and $6w$ are unlike terms.

Q5 **False**. It equals $25m^2 + 60mn + 36n^2$.

Q6 (a) **Both true, R explains A**. The $2ab$ term is missing.

Short answer

Q7 **Correct: $15p^2 - 6pq$** . The $-3p$ must be multiplied, not added.

Q8 **Correct: $5x + 10$** . The constants are $-2 + 12 = 10$, not 3.

Q9 **Correct: $5a^3 + 6a^2b + 6ab^2$** . $6a^2b$ and $6ab^2$ are unlike terms and cannot be combined.

Long answer

Q10 **Correct: $25m^2 + 60mn + 36n^2$** . The middle term $2 \times 5m \times 6n = 60mn$ was omitted.

Q11 $x^2 + 7x + 10$. $x \times x + x \times 5 + 2 \times x + 2 \times 5 = x^2 + 5x + 2x + 10$.

Q12 **Correct: $3y + 4$** . $y + 2(y + 2)$ means $y + 2y + 4$ (the 2 multiplies only the bracket); it is not $(y + 2)^2$.

Total: 21 marks.